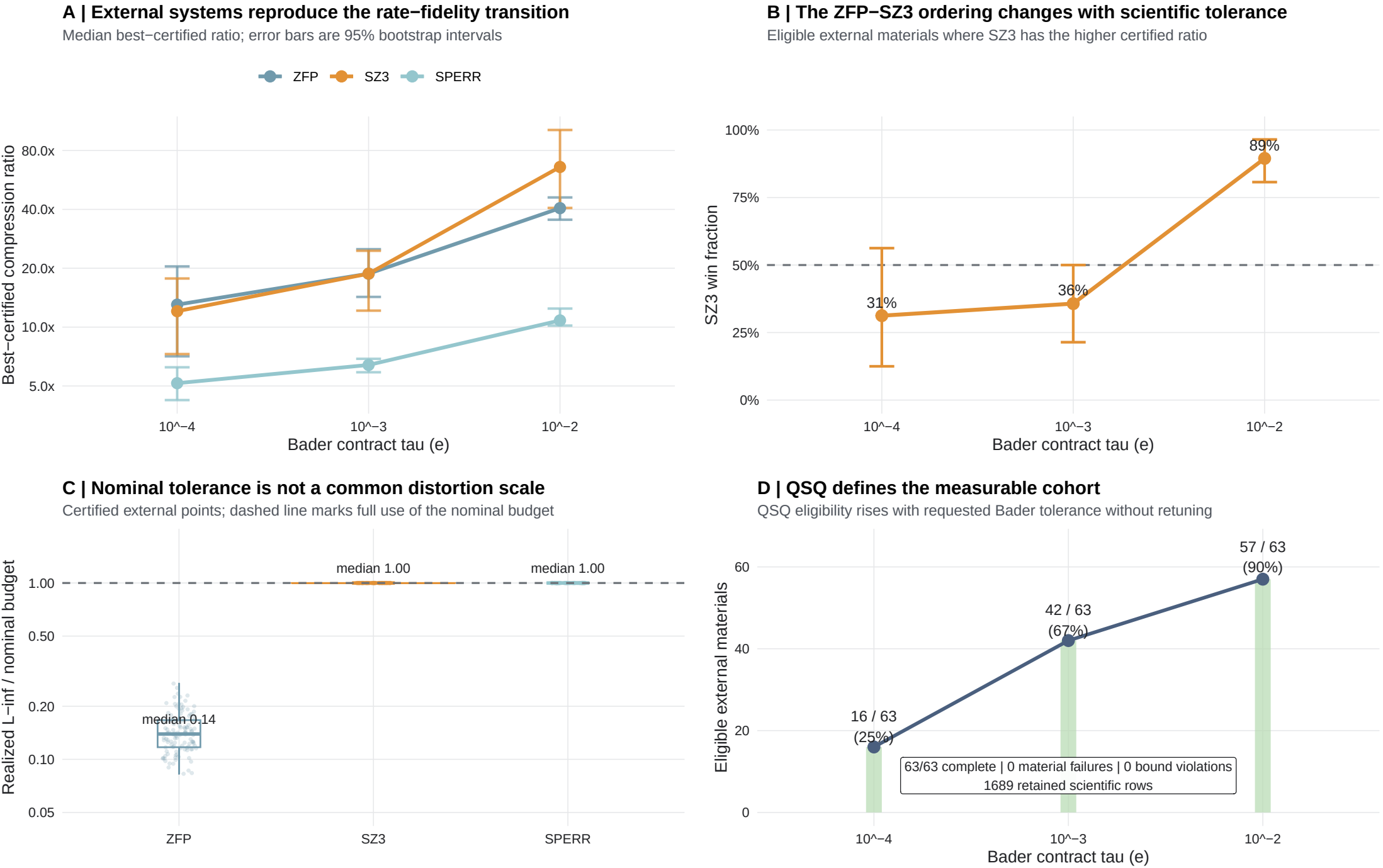


Figure 8 | Untouched external systems reproduce the stability-qualified decision frontier

The pre-specified 63-system cohort preserves the codec-ordering transition, realized-distortion asymmetry, and QSQ eligibility logic without retuning.



External confirmatory cohort: 63/63 observed systems completed, 1,689 retained scientific rows, zero material-level pipeline failures and zero codec-bound violations. Pairwise intervals and compression-ratio intervals are the external bootstrap summaries.